DAAD EPOS: the upper-third requirement and what DTU can prove

Phase 8, 8 Nov 2026. daad.de and the official EPOS list were blocked in this session, so EPOS facts are E2/E3. Confirm them in a browser

1. Verdict

- **Do not assume 2.62 meets the upper third.** On the CGPA alone, EPOS is **unlikely**.
- **Only an official DTU rank letter can decide it.** Without one, the EPOS application is not possible.
- **Timing:** only the **Aug–Oct 2027** deadlines (2028 entry) are realistic, because your degree turns six years old on **14 Jul 2028**.
- **Status:** next cycle; **conditional**. Label **B if the rank letter shows the upper third, otherwise D**.

2. The rule (E2/E3)

Requirement	Wording found	Evidence	Your position
Academic result	“an academic degree with **far above average results (upper third)**”	E2 (EPOS descriptions via search)	**Unproven**: needs a rank letter
Proof of the upper third	Universities state that applicants without a ranking letter are **excluded** by DAAD (Freiburg EPOS page). One course asks for a “top half” letter when the German grade is weaker than 2.5 (conflicting)	E2	Ask the DTU Registrar (request below)
Work experience	At least **two years of related professional experience after the first degree**	E2	0 months documented today; your statement would give about 42 months (`15_EMPLOYMENT_EVIDENCE/Experience_Calculation.xlsx`)
Age of the degree	Last degree **not older than six years**	E2/E3	Turns 6 on **14 Jul 2028**
Choice of courses	Up to three courses from the current EPOS list; you apply to the university	E2	No ICT course confirmed yet (section 5)

3. Where 2.62 stands (indicative only)

- **Modified Bavarian formula** (the method German universities commonly use):

  German grade = 1 + 3 × (best − yours) ÷ (best − minimum pass)

  = 1 + 3 × (4.00 − 2.62) ÷ (4.00 − 2.00) = **3.07**

- On the German scale, 1.0 is the best grade and 4.0 is a pass. **3.1 is “satisfactory”**, not “far above average”.

- **Assumption:** the minimum passing CGPA is **2.00**, which is usual in Ethiopia but **not yet confirmed for DTU**. The registrar's grading-scale letter will confirm it.
- **The official conversion is made by the university or uni-assist, not by us.** This figure is only a warning sign.
- **What could still work:** class rank is about your position in **your** cohort. If the Extension-programme cohort's grades were low overall, 2.62 could still rank in the upper third. **Only DTU's records can show this.**

4. What DTU can issue (to confirm with the Registrar)

Document	What it states	Use
Class rank letter (best)	"ranked **X** out of **Y** graduates of BSc Computer Science (Extension programme), graduating July 2022"	Upper third if X ≤ Y ÷ 3
Percentile statement	"in the top __ % of the graduating class"	Upper third if within the top 33 %
Cohort grade distribution	Number of graduates in each CGPA band	Lets the university judge your position
Grading scale and minimum pass	Scale and the minimum CGPA to graduate (already requested)	Needed for any German grade conversion

Already requested: the University Registrar request in `09_APPLICATION_DOCUMENTS/00_Document_Collection_Kit` asks for "a certificate of my class rank or percentile within my graduating cohort" (item 5). The paragraph below makes the EPOS purpose explicit. Add it only when you hand in the request; **nothing has been sent**.

> **Additional request (DAAD EPOS):** For the German DAAD EPOS scholarship, I kindly request an official letter, on University letterhead, signed and stamped, stating my **rank in my graduating class**, for example "ranked __ out of __ graduates of the BSc in Computer Science (Extension programme), graduating July 2022". If the University does not rank students individually, a statement of my **percentile** or the **distribution of cumulative GPAs** in my graduating class would help. Please also state the **minimum CGPA required to graduate** and the grading scale.

5. IT-related EPOS courses (prioritised as you asked)

- **No IT, information-systems or computer-science course was confirmed on the EPOS list.** The official list (DAAD "deadlines 2027/28" PDF and the EPOS brochure) was blocked here, and search results showed no ICT course (E2).
- **Nearest IT-adjacent course found:** HFT Stuttgart, MSc Photogrammetry and Geoinformatics (E2: the university publishes DAAD prerequisites).
  - It fits only if you have real GIS or remote-sensing work, and your profile shows none. Weak fit.
- **Your step (10 minutes, in a browser):**
  1. Open **daad.de/epos-info**, then the EPOS brochure or list.
  2. Search it for "information", "ICT", "computer", "data", "digital" and "geo".
  3. For each match, note the deadline, the language test, and how "related professional experience" is defined.
  4. Add the matches to `DASHBOARD/Scholarship_Command_Center.xlsx` (S22).

6. Decision rule

1. **Rank letter shows the upper third** → choose up to 3 IT-related EPOS courses and apply to the **Aug–Oct 2027** deadlines with documented work experience (≥ 24 months related, after graduation).
2. **Rank letter shows you are not in the upper third** → **do not apply to EPOS** (label D). Spend the effort on Chevening and ASU.
3. **DTU cannot rank you** → EPOS is not possible (the ranking letter is a stated requirement). Keep the grading-scale letter for other applications.